NCFE Level 2 Functional Skills Qualification in English (603/5054/4): Reading

Paper Number: Sample Assessment Materials

Mark Scheme v1.0 Pre-standardisation

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Section 1

1	Give **one** way that Text 1 says digital tickets benefit the environment. **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • eliminate the need for printing (1) • save paper / ink / other materials (1) • do not end up in landfills (1) • minimising carbon footprint. (1) **Accept** similar wording. **Accept** any other valid benefit.	1	2.11

2	Give **two** quotations from Text 1 that suggest that the bus app will save passengers time. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks from: • 'Buy tickets in seconds' (1) • 'real-time information' (1) • 'journey planner maps out the quickest routes'. (1) **Accept** any other valid quotation. **Accept** full sentence that includes the quotation.	2	2.18

3	According to Text 1, who should you contact about a disabled person's bus pass? **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark for: • (local) council. (1)	1	2.16

4	In Text 1, what is implied by the phrase, 'takes the hassle out of public transport'? **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • public transport is not convenient (1) • it makes using public transport easier. (1) **Accept** any other valid inference.	1	2.13

5 Identify whether **each** of the following quotations from Text 1 is an example of an **instructional** or a **persuasive** style.

[2 marks]

Maximum two marks from:

Quotation	Instructional or Persuasive
Choose your location, select and purchase a ticket.	**Instructional**
As your tickets get sent straight to your phone, you'll never need to queue for tickets again!	**Persuasive**

2 | 2.19

6 What problem does Text 1 warn readers to be aware of if using the app?

[1 mark]

Maximum one mark for:

- flat battery. (1)

Accept similar wording.

1 | 2.16

7 Give **one** quotation for each of the following features used in Text 1.

(a) Rule of three

[1 mark]

Maximum one mark from:

- day savers, season tickets and family passes (1)
- journeys, services and stops. (1)

Accept full sentence that includes the language feature.

1 | 2.14

(b) Rhetorical question

[1 mark]

Maximum one mark from:

- Not travelling straight away? (1)
- Low battery? (1)
- Running late? (1)
- Do you have somewhere you need to get to? (1)

Accept full sentence that includes the language feature.

1 | 2.14

8	What does the word ‘retrieve’ mean, as used in Text 1? You may use a dictionary to help you answer this question. **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • find (1) • bring back. (1) **Accept** similar wording.	1	2.15

Section 2

9	According to Text 2, what is the first thing that goes wrong in the app for Olly? **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark for: • bus disappears from the screen. (1) **Accept** similar wording.	1	2.11

10	What is the meaning of the word 'optimistic' as used in Text 2? You may use a dictionary to answer this question. **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark for / from: • hoping that good things will happen. (1) **Accept** valid / appropriate definition.	1	2.15

11	Use Text 2 to answer the following: (a) Identify the language feature used in this quotation: 'The bus was packed full like a tin of sardines' **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark for: • simile. (1)	1	2.14
	(b) Find **one** example of alliteration. **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • complete catastrophe (1) • really relaxed (1) • slightly stressed. (1) **Accept** two-word example of alliteration. Do **not** accept Monday morning.	1	2.14

12	Which **two** of the following quotations from Text 2 are examples of informal language? **[2 marks]** **A** By now, I was feeling extremely sorry for myself **B** However, the bus was nowhere to be seen **C** I dropped my mates a text **D** I left home at 8 am as planned **E** The app totally messed up		
	Maximum one mark for:		
	Answers: **C** I dropped my mates a text (1) **E** The app totally messed up (1)	2	2.17

13	Use Text 2 to answer the following. Olly's phone battery goes flat. Give **two** ways he is affected. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks from: • (that) Olly would have no lunch / have no money for lunch (1) • (that) Olly had no money for bus fare home / (that) Olly would need to make new plans for his journey home (1) • Olly could not show his ticket to the driver. (1) **Accept** any other valid inference.	2	2.13

14	Identify **two** things Olly did using the app in Text 2 that are mentioned in Text 1. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks from: • used journey planner / planned journey (1) • used live bus tracker (1) • activated ticket. (1)	2	2.12

Section 3

15	Apart from buying tickets, give **one** other benefit of the ticket office for passengers mentioned in Text 3. **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark from: • personal contact with staff (1) • assistance / accessibility feature (1) • information (1) • makes them feel safe. (1) **Accept** any other valid benefit.	1	2.11

16	Text 3 includes facts and opinions. Identify **two** facts about passengers. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks from: • There has been a huge increase in online shopping in the UK (1) • Customer and passenger behaviour has changed (1) • 80% of the population made online purchases in 2024 (1) • more passengers are now using their mobile phones to plan journeys (1) • not all passengers have access to the internet (1) • some passengers rely on staff / ticket office. (1) **Accept** any other valid response**.**	2	2.18

17	Give **two** quotations that show Trisha Molumby is biased about the FareTravel Bus app. **[2 marks]**		
	Maximum two marks from: • ‘makes bus travel incredibly easy for everyone’ (1) • ‘best thing since sliced bread’ (1) • ‘everything you need in one place’. (1) **Accept** any other valid quotations.	2	2.17

18	What does the writer of Text 3 imply when she says Molumby's view 'may be hard to take'? **[1 mark]** **A** It is aggressive **B** It is enthusiastic **C** It is insensitive **D** It is unclear		
	Maximum one mark for:		
	Answer: **C** It is insensitive (1)	1	2.13

19	Where did the writer of Text 3 get their information about customer behaviour? **[1 mark]**		
	Maximum one mark for: • Customer and Commerce UK (2025). (1) **Accept** Customer and Commerce UK.	1	2.16

20	Which word **best** describes the tone used in Text 3? **[1 mark]** **A** Challenging **B** Conversational **C** Enthusiastic **D** Objective		
	Maximum one mark for:		
	Answer: **D** Objective (1)	1	2.19

21	Which **one** of the following statements about Text 2 **and** Text 3 is correct? **[1 mark]** **A** Both texts encourage readers to purchase tickets online **B** Both texts explain the impact of the FareTravel Bus app on passengers **C** Both texts give information about purchasing tickets online **D** Both texts instruct passengers on how to use the FareTravel Bus app		
	Maximum one mark for:		
	Answer: **B** Both texts explain the impact of the FareTravel Bus app on passengers (1)	1	2.12

[Total: 30 marks]

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